

► Devils in disguise

For witch hunters such as Matthew Hopkins, the presence of small creatures in someone's home might be grounds to accuse the person of witchcraft. Despite the affectionate names recorded for familiars, such as Vinegar Tom or Griezzell Greedigutt, they were believed to be demonic, not real animals.



“Elizabeth desired first of the said cat that she might be rich and have goods ...”

REPORTED CONFESSION OF ELIZABETH FRANCIS, CHELMSFORD WITCH TRIAL, 1566